Ugur Mert Yasar

umy@chicagobooth.edu · umyasar@fas.harvard.edu · ugurmertyasar.com

Education

The University of Chicago Booth School of Business, IL Expected *June 2027*
PhD, Behavioral Science
MBA
Harvard University, MA *July 2026 – June 2027*
Visiting PhD Student, Department of Psychology
University of British Columbia, BC *June 2020*
Bachelor of International Economics, Vancouver School of Economics
Thesis: Islamic Rule's Effects on Women's Labor Force Participation: Evidence from Turkey

Doctoral Dissertation

Title: The Institutional Architecture of Norms and Enforcement
Committee: Joshua Conrad Jackson (Chair), James A. Robinson, Devin Pope, Joshua T. Dean, Thomas Talhelm

Research Interests

Rules, norms, cultural tightness, institutional economics, social learning, argumentativeness

Working Papers

1. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., Yao, H., Kowal, M., & Sorokowski, P. "The Global Architecture of Social Norms: Content and Enforcement." *[**Job Market Paper**; data analysis in progress]*
2. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., Sahakari, S., & Götz, F. "Rulebooks and Relationships: An Institutional Model of Cultural Tightness." *[Invited proposal,* Perspectives on Psychological Science*]*
3. **Yasar, U. M.**, & Jackson, J. C. "Kin is King: Familial Status Inflation in Non-WEIRD Cultures." *[Complete manuscript available on request]*
4. Jackson, J. C., **Yasar, U. M.**, Liu, Y., & Dorison, C. "Social Learning Can Produce Costly Status Quo Preferences Without a Status Quo Bias." *[Complete manuscript available on request]*

Work in Progress

5. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., Yao, H., Kowal, M., & Sorokowski, P. "Deconstructing Cultural Tightness: Formal and Informal Dimensions of Norm Enforcement Across 92 Cultures." *[Data analysis in progress]*
6. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., Yao, H., Kowal, M., & Sorokowski, P. "Cultural Tightness-Looseness Revisited After 15 Years: Updated Scores and Correlates Across 92 Cultures." *[Data analysis in progress]*
7. **Yasar, U. M.**, Talhelm, T., Wei, L., Kowal, M., & Sorokowski, P. "Argumentativeness as a Cultural Trait: Self-Reports and Culture-Reports Across 92 Countries." *[Data analysis in progress]*
8. **Yasar, U. M.**, Zhang, S., & Jackson, J. C. "Substitutes or Complements? Formal and Informal Enforcement in a Public Goods Game." *[Pilot data analysis]*
9. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., & Pope, D. "Enemy at the Board: How Political Tension Predicts Unsportsmanlike Behavior in International Chess." *[Data analysis in progress]*

Awards and Honors

Global Health Summer Fellowship, Center for Global Health, The University of Chicago — $7,500 *2023*

Development Economics Research Fund, Becker Friedman Institute, The University of Chicago — $4,578 *(Declined)* *2022*

Work-Learn International Undergraduate Research Award, University of British Columbia — CAD $7,000 *2018*

Outstanding Practicum Award, University of British Columbia — CAD $8,000 *2015*

Presentations

"The Global Architecture of Social Norms: Content and Enforcement" Yasar, U. M., & Jackson, J. C.

- *Organized Symposium* (Co-Chair): "The Lifecycle of Norms: Novel Insights from Around the World," Society for Personality and Social Psychology, Chicago (February 2026)
- *Talk*: International Association for Conflict Management, Burlington (July 2025)

"Kin is King: Familial Status Inflation in Non-WEIRD Cultures" Yasar, U. M., & Jackson, J. C.

- *Talk*: Society for Personality and Social Psychology, Denver (February 2025)
- *Invited Talk*: Behavioral Brownbag, Booth School of Business, The University of Chicago (May 2024)

"Argumentativeness as a Cultural Trait: Self-Reports and Culture-Reports Across 92 Countries" Yasar, U. M., Talhelm, T., & Wei, L.

- *Poster*: Global Health Research Symposium, Biological Sciences Division, The University of Chicago (October 2023)

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, The University of Chicago

The Study of Behavioral Economics *Winter 2024, 2025, 2026*
MBA, Chicago · *Professor Devin Pope*

Statistics *Autumn 2024 – Winter 2025*
Executive MBA, Hong Kong and London · *Professor Chris Hansen*

Behavioral Economics: Development and Observational Data *Autumn 2023*
PhD, Chicago · *Professors Devin Pope and Joshua T. Dean*

Managerial Decision Making *Autumn 2023*
Executive MBA, Hong Kong · *Professor Chris Hsee*

Behavioral Economics: Theory and the Lab *Spring 2023*
PhD, Chicago · *Professor Alex Imas*

Behavioral Economics *Spring 2023*
Undergraduate, Chicago · *Professor Alex Imas*

Research Experience

Research Assistant *2020 – 2021*
Vancouver School of Economics, University of British Columbia · *Professor Matt Lowe*

Research Assistant, Culture and Self Lab *2019 – 2021*
University of British Columbia · *Professor Steven J. Heine*

Research Assistant, Motivation and Goals in Contexts (MAGIC) Lab *2018 – 2021*
University of British Columbia · *Professor Kristin Laurin*

Research Assistant *2018*
Sauder School of Business, University of British Columbia · *Professor Álvaro Parra*

Skills

Software R, Stata, Python, SPSS, Qualtrics

Languages Turkish (native), English (fluent), Spanish (beginner)